



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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Power tips to succeed in 2024

Here are some ways in which athletes can **optimise** their performance this new year.

For athletes, appropriate nutrition and performance enhancement should always go hand-in-hand.

The quest of excellence is an ongoing journey for all sportspersons, from seasoned pros to aspiring athletes. The proverb — *You are what you eat* — is especially true for athletes.

Here are a few recommendations to help your body thrive in your respective sport this new year.

1. Recognise the needs of your sport

Evaluate the energy and nutritional needs that are specific to your sport. For best results, adjust your diet to fulfill these requirements.

2. Align with your genes

Genetic testing for nutrition can help you reach your full sporting potential, pinpointing specific nutritional demands and existing deficiencies. It can also help identify fitness tests based on physical requirements for strong/weak areas and personality tests that enhance mental function. Adapt your strategy based on individual findings from these tests to improve athletic performance.

3. Tiny microbiomes can do big things

Nobody can perform well with an upset stomach. Microbiome testing can provide important information

about gut health and how it is affecting performance. Athletes can maximise nutrition, strengthen immunity, and increase energy levels by examining the microbial population in their digestive systems. This gives them greater chances of gaining optimal physical condition and enhanced overall well-being.

4. Blood test for performance

Blood tests can significantly impact athletes' performance. They can learn more about their health issues, triggering parameters and existing nutrition deficiencies by evaluating important biomarkers. Through specific adaptations based on individual data, athletes can achieve unprecedented levels of excellence by improving their training, recuperation, and performance.

5. Tech-based recovery

Athletic performance can be enhanced with state-of-the-art recovery technology. These devices, which range from vibrating foam rollers to percussive instruments, improve circulation, reduce muscular discomfort, and speed up the healing process. Additionally, they are mobile-friendly and easy to use.

6. Omega balance

Omega balance test checks the body's ratio of Omega-3 to Omega-6 fatty acids. Maintaining a balanced ratio helps in lowering inflammation, promoting cardiovascular health,

and speeding up recovery, thus leading to optimal performance and improved overall strength, resilience, and endurance.

7. VO2 max score

Athletes' maximum utilisation of oxygen during strenuous activity is determined by their VO2 max test results. Increased aerobic capacity, endurance, and general cardiovascular fitness are linked to greater VO2 max values, which have a direct impact on an athlete's capability to maintain high-intensity effort and improve performance.

8. Body composition

An examination of body composition determines how much muscle, fat, and other components make up the body. An ideal body composition, with the right amount of fat and muscle, improves strength-to-weight ratio, agility, and efficiency — all important components in a variety of sports.

9. Make sleep your best friend

Sleeping well is essential for doing well in sports. The body heals itself, produces growth hormone, and solidifies memories when you sleep soundly.

Sufficient and peaceful sleep promotes physical restoration, sharpens cognitive abilities, and increases vitality, all of which are factors in peak performance and resilience.